

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

Prompting Basics: Getting Useful Results Every Time

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session that turns AI access into AI skill, and leaves your school with a growing shared prompt library. Run by your own coach or teacher-leader; no consultant required.

Why this matters now

The 2025 Gallup survey of 2,232 teachers found that weekly AI users save about 5.9 hours a week, roughly six weeks a year, while 40% of teachers don't use AI at all. Access is identical; skill is not. Prompting is the learnable skill that closes that gap, and researchers who tested structured prompts against casual ones measured response-quality gains of more than half. This session teaches the skill in one hour and installs the habit system that keeps it growing.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Write four-part prompts (role · task · context · format) instead of vague requests
- Apply the "colleague test" before submitting any prompt
- Iterate deliberately: content, voice, details, instead of settling for first drafts
- Own one reusable prompt template for a weekly task, built during the session
- Contribute to a shared staff prompt library that compounds all year
- State what prompting can't fix: verification and judgment stay human

Research base in brief

Skill gap & time savings: Gallup–Walton Family Foundation (2025) · Prompt structure evidence: Bsharat et al. (2024, preprint); White et al., PLoP (2023) · Practice frameworks: OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google official guidance; NC Dept. of Public Instruction CRAFT framework (2024); AI for Education Five-S model · Adoption context: RAND RR-A134-25 (2025). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 2 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**, after Kit 1 establishes the safety rules. Ships with a 30-day plan (three 10-minute PLC follow-ups that grow the prompt library, no new meetings) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Zero student data anywhere: the skills are practiced on teacher tasks only.

The compounding asset: most PD evaporates; this session leaves a shared prompt library that gets more valuable every week your staff uses it. By Kit 18 it becomes a formal, organized collection.

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi, a husband-and-wife team of certified educators with over 20 combined years in the classroom (CTE Carpentry; K-8). © AI-Ready School. Informational, not legal advice; consult district counsel before adopting policy. Check with your district or state whether this PD qualifies for local credit.